

Mold.log

Application by Darius Nazarov (OGOxWOW Buro), Belgrade, Serbia

Darius Nazarov · OGOxWOW Buro · ogowow.buro@gmail.com · +7 985 884 37 27 · t.me/dariy_nazarov · @ogowow_buro

Functional link for the jury (no app, any recent iOS/Android browser or desktop):

<https://dariyxyz.github.io/petri-mold/>

Playable version: <https://dariyxyz.github.io/petri-mold/>

Images and gameplay teaser:

https://drive.google.com/drive/folders/1zaVo7N3MKv_c3ov3awPn4lomXxDs-FVz

Source: <https://github.com/DariyXYZ/petri-mold>



1. Artistic Documentation

Concept statement

Mold.log is a browser-based generative artwork where the visitor grows digital mold in a virtual Petri dish. They place spores, choose a strain (named after real fungi and bacteria), and watch the colonies branch, layer and collide, while each colony adds its own voice to a slowly building soundscape. The image is monochrome and pixelated, like a laboratory record; the visitor can pause, burn the dish clean and start over, and export any moment as a PNG.

The work came out of my own unease with mold — the invisible world that quietly eats the spaces we live in. Turning it into something observable and reversible is how I make peace with it; I want to give visitors the same shift from discomfort to curiosity. It fits the 2027 theme 'From Code to Culture' literally: a few hundred lines of growth rules become a shared, playable culture — in both senses of the word.

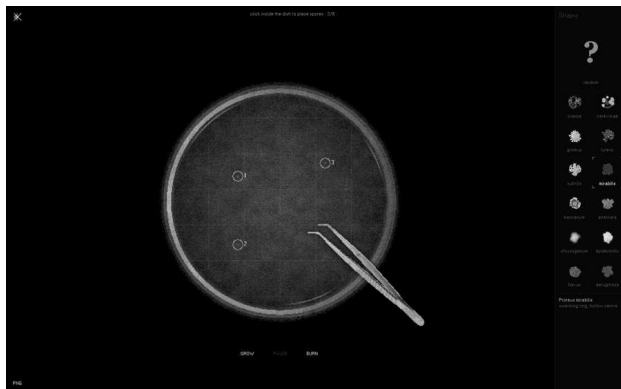
Site integration rationale

Megève in January is a landscape of snow, wood and stone — surfaces on which nothing grows. Mold.log places a warm, living-looking process in that frozen street: a Petri dish glowing on a phone in a visitor's gloved hand. The Dibond panel shows one printed 'record' of a grown dish; the QR code opens the live experiment. The contrast — alpine cold outside, microbial growth inside the screen — is the point. If selected, I will add a Megève-specific strain: a colony whose growth pattern is derived from the outline of the Mont d'Arbois / Rochebrune ridgelines, so that visitors can 'grow the mountain' in their dish (the strain is generated from open elevation data, no new assets required).

Intended audience journey

1) A passer-by sees the easel: a black panel with a white, dithered Petri dish and the words 'Grow it yourself' in French and English. 2) They scan the QR code; the work opens instantly in the phone browser, no app, no sign-in, ~5 MB. 3) They tap the dish to place spores and pick a strain; within 20–60 seconds colonies fill the dish and the sound starts (headphones optional; sound is off by default outdoors). 4) They can BURN and start over, or export a PNG of their dish — a souvenir of Megève made of digital mold. 5) The permanent EXPO page links back to the work, so the experiment continues at home. During the official presence hours I stand by the easel and run dishes with visitors.

Visual mock-ups



Left: strain panel and early growth (this is what a visitor sees on a phone in landscape / on desktop). Right: BURN. Panel mock-up: black Dibond, printed dish from the exported PNG at print resolution, bilingual caption, QR code.

2. Technical Dossier

Platform / engine	Plain HTML5 + JavaScript (Canvas 2D, Web Audio). No framework, no server side, no tracking.
Hosting plan	GitHub Pages (static, CDN-backed, HTTPS), already live at dariyxyz.github.io/petri-mold. A mirror on a second static host will be added for the EXPO week. Uptime is the artist's responsibility; a static site has no moving parts to fail.
Device compatibility	Recent iOS Safari and Android Chrome, plus any desktop browser. Touch input supported (tap = place spore). Tested on iPhone/Android; UI scales to portrait and landscape.
Performance	Total assets $\approx$ 5 MB; first load 2–4 s on 4G; runs at 30–60 fps on phones from 2019 onwards. The simulation runs on a low-resolution grid, so it is light on batteries in the cold.
Geolocation / anchoring	Not required — the work is a web experience opened by QR code, not location-based AR. (Optional: the Megève ridgeline strain is a static addition, no GPS needed.)
Connectivity	Needs internet only for the first load; afterwards runs offline in the tab. No accounts, no data collection.
QR / no-app access	Confirmed: accessible via QR code without any app. Direct URL works on all devices.
Robustness outdoors	Nothing physical beyond the EXPO-provided easel and panel. The digital piece has no backend to overload; high footfall only increases CDN traffic. A fallback QR to the mirror host will be printed on the panel.
Language	Interface text is minimal (strain names in Latin, PAUSE / BURN / PNG). A French/English toggle will be added before the 5 November link deadline; all panel text is bilingual.
Sound	Generative, low-volume, switchable; off by default on mobile so it never plays unexpectedly in the street.

3. Compliance Statement

I confirm that: the content is family-friendly and contains no living biological material, no violence, no text or imagery unsuitable for children; all text and audio will be available in both French and English; the work is my own original creation (Darius Nazarov, 2026) and I hold all rights to it; I accept the Official Open Call terms and conditions published on the Digital Art EXPO website, which take precedence; I am responsible for hosting, uptime and device compatibility; I will provide the final QR link by 5 November 2026 and intend to be present in Megève during the official programme hours on 8–10 January 2027, travel and accommodation at my own expense.

4. Artist

Darius Nazarov is an artist based in Belgrade, Serbia, trained in parametric architecture. His practice spans experimental Art & Science games and media installations, using digital systems to explore natural processes and the emotions they provoke. He represents OGOxWOW Buro, an art collective bringing together several artists, and presents Mold.log as an individual author.

Previous presentations: Signal (2024), Archstoyanie (2024), Architecton with SA Lab, ExtraLives at Boston Cyberarts Gallery (2026), Video Game Artshow at Another Corner.

Darius Nazarov · OGOxWOW Buro · ogowow.buro@gmail.com · +7 985 884 37 27 · t.me/dariy_nazarov · [@ogowow_buro](https://www.instagram.com/ogowow_buro)

Belgrade, 21 September 2026